

GOALS

Commitment is not imposed, it is built.

How to set the goal the team actually chases.

AND THE CONSEQUENCE

The number can be the same, the outcome never is.

THE CASCADE

How a goal becomes slide decoration.



WHAT YOU SEE

The goal comes down finished, from the board...



THE MECHANISM

...it is announced once, with plenty of enthusiasm...



THE CONSEQUENCE

...and vanishes from the conversation until results day.

A goal that only shows up under pressure was never a goal, it was an expectation.

THE FORK

A goal has to pass three filters.

THREE FILTERS

01

Can it be measured with no argument? If not, it is a wish.

02

Does it fit in six months? Longer than that moves nobody.

03

Does it have a named owner? Everyone's goal is nobody's goal.

If one of the three is missing, the problem is not the team, it is the wording.

THE METHOD

The commitment thermometer.

01 **IMPOSED**

the team hits it as far as the pressure reaches, and stops there

02 **ANNOUNCED**

the team understands and repeats it, but does not own it

03 **BUILT**

the team defends the goal when an outsider questions it

The difference between the first and the third is one ninety minute meeting.

IN PRACTICE, IN ORDER

How to build the goal together.

01 • IMPOSED

Bring the problem, not the number.

start with what has to change, and why now

02 • ANNOUNCED

Let the team do the math on the path.

whoever builds the math believes it, whoever receives it does not

03 • BUILT

Ask what stands in the way of getting there.

this is where the blocker only you can remove shows up

04

Close the goal sentence together.

number, deadline, owner, in one line everyone repeats

TWO MODELS

A goal that weighs or a goal that pulls.

THE COMMON MODEL

A goal that weighs

Arrives finished and closed

Measures effort and activity

Only shows up under pressure

Enthusiasm drops in three weeks

THE DESIGNED MODEL

A goal that pulls

Born from the problem, with the team

Measures a result the team controls

Shows up weekly in the ritual

Holds the pace for six months

MISTAKE AND CONSEQUENCE

Three mistakes that hollow out the number.

01 Setting a number with no path.

→ doubling without saying with what is a bet, not a goal.

02 Picking a metric the team does not control.

→ nobody commits to something that depends on luck.

03 Never mentioning the goal between one review and the next.

→ the silence teaches that it is not a real priority.

A goal nobody can recite is already dead, it just has not been buried.

THE CHAIN

The closed document test.

01

Close the document and call one person on the team, unannounced.



02

Ask for the goal for this half in one sentence, and their part in it.



03

Did they need to open the slide? The goal does not exist, a slide does.



WHERE LEADERSHIP STEPS IN

A good goal fits in the team's mouth with no document to check.

RUN IT THIS WAY NEXT TIME

How to turn a wish into a goal.

▣ STEP 01 Rewrite the goal as one sentence with number, date and owner. if it does not fit on one line, it is still vague	▣ STEP 02 Book ninety minutes with the team to build the path. you bring the problem, they build the math	■ STEP 03 Put the goal in the weekly ritual, even when it is healthy. a goal remembered every week survives the third month
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| Whoever takes part in the math defends the result.

THE MODEL THAT STICKS

The Commitment Thermometer, in the order that matters.



**A goal that does not commit does not move.
And commitment is not imposed, it is built.**

SAVE THIS FOR LATER

in your next round of goal setting.

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MANAGEMENT AS ENGINEERING
/IN/FALERCIA